

THE PLAYER-COACH PLAYBOOK

Lesson 6

The Victory Lap and the Next Season

About 60 minutes this week. Your core rep, Drill 6.3, is the Championship Conversation with your Athleader.

M.V.P. Accelerator™

POWERED BY ATHLEADERSHIP ARENA™

LESSON 6 · GOES WITH VIDEO 6.1

Pre-Game Huddle: Your Focus for Lesson 6

Welcome to your final lesson, Player-Coach. This isn't just an ending; it's a commencement. It's about celebrating the progress you and your Athleader have made, solidifying the learning to ensure it sticks, and intentionally planning for what comes next.

A true victory isn't just finishing the experience; it's using the momentum to fuel the next season of growth.

"The final whistle of one season is the starting pistol for the next. Celebrate the win, but never forget what it takes to win again."

This week's A.R.A.W. focus:

All four

Your Objectives for this Lesson:

- Reflect on and create a system to cement your own new leadership habits.
- Master the "Championship Conversation" to celebrate your Athleader's success and provide career-accelerating visibility.
- Create a clear coaching plan for your Athleader's next 90-day season of growth.



START HERE

Drill 6.3: The Championship Conversation

Your core rep this week, about 30 minutes.

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LESSON 6 · ABOUT 60 MINUTES OF REPS THIS WEEK

A.R.A.W. Conditioning Drills

Lead self first, then lead others. Your core rep is the conversation that makes your Athleader's season visible.

Drill 6.2

EXTRA REP, IF YOU HAVE TIME

Cementing Your Leadership Habits

All four · lead self

15 min

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Drill 6.3

CORE REP · START HERE

The Championship Conversation

Alignment · lead others

30 min

Page 5 ›

Assessment

REQUIRED · AT THE END OF THIS LESSON

Your post-assessment and your 180

All four · in the course

20 min

Page 8 ›

Fill it in on screen. Type straight into the grey boxes and tick the boxes that apply. Save the file to keep your answers.

Or on paper. Print the pages and write by hand.

Then get feedback. Complete your core rep, then ask your Athleader how the conversation went.

Drill 6.2 | Extra rep, if you have time | About 15 minutes · Goes with Video 6.2

LEAD SELF: Cementing Your Leadership Habits

The goal of this experience was to help you build new leadership habits, not just learn new ideas. This drill is about making them permanent by building a system around your most impactful new practice.

My Leadership Habit Integration Plan

Step 1

Identify Your Most Impactful New Habit

Look back through this Playbook. What is the one new practice or framework (e.g., the Energy Audit, the Agility Coaching Question, the Forward-Looking Feedback model) that has been most valuable for you as a leader?

Step 2

Schedule the Habit (Build Your System)

How will you build a system to ensure this practice continues? Be specific about the trigger and the schedule.

My System

Recurring slot: _____

Trigger: _____

Someone who'd notice if I stopped: _____

Example

If it were the Energy Audit, your system might be: "Every Friday at 2 p.m. (my trigger), I will block 15 minutes on my calendar (my system) to review the week's energy and plan for the next."

In the video, a practice lasts when it has a recurring slot, a clear trigger, and someone who'd notice if you stopped. Choose one or two.

Drill 6.3 | Core rep · start here | About 30 minutes · Goes with Videos 6.3 and 6.4

LEAD OTHERS: The Championship Conversation

This is your final, most important play call. Your task is to hold the Championship Conversation, designed to make your Athleader's success visible and sustainable. This playbook breaks it down into three critical parts.

Part 1: CELEBRATE

Recognition fuels motivation. How will you acknowledge your Athleader's growth and commitment? Check all that apply and add your ideas.

Ask how they like to be recognized first. Some people want public praise, and others would rather hear it privately.

- [ ] Acknowledge their specific growth and contribution in our next team meeting.
- [ ] Send a recognition email highlighting their key accomplishment to our team and key stakeholders.
- [ ] Nominate them for a formal company award or recognition program.
- [ ] Thank them one-on-one, in the way they prefer, naming a specific project.

My Own Idea

Part 2: PROVIDE Visibility

Advocacy accelerates careers. This is a key theme from your assessment. How will you use your influence to give them exposure to senior leadership?

A key senior leader: _____

Who is one leader whose awareness of your Athleader's work would be beneficial for their career?

Plan the connection. Choose your play:

- ☐ **The Introduction** Schedule a brief, informal 15-minute virtual coffee for the three of us.
- ☐ **The Strategic Update** Send a concise note or email to that leader highlighting your Athleader's key accomplishment and how it ties to a broader business goal.

✎ The Message: What is the one key accomplishment or new skill you want to highlight?

Part 3: PLAN the Next Season: Your Athleader's Next 90-Day Focus

Momentum is built on a clear vision for what's next. Prepare your key coaching question for your final check-in this season.



"This was a great season of growth. Based on everything you've learned and accomplished, what is your primary focus or #1 goal for your next 90-day season?"

✎ Capture Their Goal

Listen and capture their response here. This becomes the foundation for your coaching conversations next quarter.

Locker Room Reflection

Challenge: Of the three plays in the Championship Conversation (Celebrate, Provide Visibility, and Plan the Next Season), which one do you believe will have the most significant long-term impact on your Athleader's career momentum and engagement at the company, and why?

This reflection goes with the real-world challenge from Video 6.4.



"What you do daily determines who you become permanently."

My notes:

Get Feedback

Complete your core rep, then ask your Athleader how the conversation went.

Who I asked: _____

What they said, and what I'll keep doing:

Back in the course: your Athleader Pro Huddle with Sagar Pandya, your Pulse Check, then your post-assessment and your 180.

FINAL STEPS

Your “Next Play”

You’ve coached a full season. Three steps close it in the course.

- [ ] **Complete your post-assessment.** The same questions you answered before Lesson 1. Your Growth Guide comes with your results.
- [ ] **Complete your 180.** Your view of how your Athleader has grown, while they give their view of how you supported them. Think about the moments you saw them lead differently this season.
- [ ] **Pay it forward on the Wall of Fame.** Share one moment from your season that showed you what had changed, or one thing you’d tell the next Player-Coach.

My notes:

Draft your few lines for the Wall of Fame here.



Thank you for coaching your Athleader through this season, and for doing your own work alongside them. That’s what a Player-Coach is. You’ve got this!



Melissa Dawn Simkins
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